lawyers from the DK, an ally of the DMK. The court had rejected both the petitions—it was clear that the lawyers had filed those petitions without actually having taken written consent from the so-called petitioners. Peraribalan and Padma were in the SIT's custody and had no access to legal consultations under the TADA.

LTTE cadres Jayakumar and Robert Payas, who were already in the SIT's custody for giving refuge to Sivarasan, told Ragothaman that one Sivaruban alias Siva was given the task of retrieving Haribabu's camera from the site. To do this, he had to ensure that he was close to Haribabu and Dhanu. Though it contradicted the confession of Murugan and Nalini, which said that Sivarasan had asked Subha Sundaram to retrieve the camera, the revelation of a new accomplice to the crime was significant.

When Nalini took Shubha and Dhanu to a tailoring shop in Purasawakkam in Madras and purchased clothes, including the orange-and-green salwar kameez, the same day, 17 May, Sivarasan and Santhan sent Sivaruban to Jaipur to finalize a hideout for the conspirators and to take one on rent under a cooked-up name.[11] The next day, when Peraribalan purchased a 9-watt golden power battery and met Sivarasan, the latter was deputing Kanagasabapathy to be ready with all arrangements in the newly acquired hideout in Delhi, which would be the pit stop for Sivarasan on his escape route to Nepal. The mastermind was setting up multiple hideouts across the country for the assassins to evade the police.

Kanth swung into action with the assistance of Jaipur Police and arrested Suresh Kumar aka Sivaruban, and his uncle Meghaja from Hotel Vikram in the city. Sivaruban, who had only one leg, had told the hotel management that he was visiting Jaipur to get an artificial limb fitted from internationally famous surgeon Dr P.K. Sethi. The SIT thought he had lost his leg in the Sriperumbudur blast and therefore was suspected to be one of the nine-member hit squad that had arrived on 1 June to kill Rajiv Gandhi and was now working on an escape route.

Kanth didn't buy Sivaruban's artificial-leg story. The other assassins in the SIT's custody had told him that Sivaruban had lost his leg in an ambush in Jaffna when he was sixteen. But he continued to be an active soldier of